



The big bang!

Light travels faster than sound. When fireworks explode high in the sky, you see the lights before you hear the loud bang. Light reaches your eyes more quickly than sound reaches your ears.



Over the rainbow

Drops of rain act like tiny prisms. When light passes through raindrops, the colors of light are split up to form a rainbow.

When a beam of light passes through a prism, the colors split apart because each wavelength is bent a different amount.

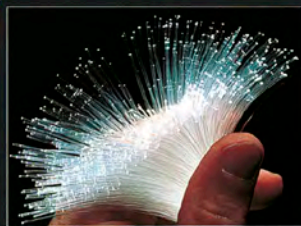
Light travels in tiny waves. Light has a mixture of different wavelengths.

A prism is a solid, triangle-shaped piece of glass or plastic.

When light passes through a convex lens, it is bent, or refracted, inward.

When light is reflected, the beams of light bounce off the mirror at the same angle as they hit it.

When light hits an object that it can't travel through, such as this mirror, a shadow forms behind the object where the light can't reach.



Busy line

When you talk on the telephone, your voice is turned into laser light signals and sent down very thin fiber glass tubes called optical fibers. Up to 150,000 different conversations can be sent down just one of these optical fibers.